

II PARKED 2026-08-27. NOT DEAD. Stephen-ruled: still a candidate for one of the first four episodes.

It does not come back as written. What comes back, if anything, is the material, under a different structure.

The defect, and it travels with the premise

A step-3 finding from ChatGPT, correct on this document's own evidence:

On Day 1 Ally knows the workplace and Kerry's first name, while C1 confirms that supervisor Osei may voluntarily speak. Ally can ask whether Kerry worked there without revealing the Tip Line message; Osei can confirm her shifts, disappearance and replacement by Leah. **His authority does not change on Day 8. Naming Kerry is therefore the safest official route, not the only lawful route**, which makes the declared engine decorative under the spine's own stated kill rule.

C1 and C3 contradict each other on the same page and C1 is right. The engine was "naming the dead woman is the ONLY lawful route to the living one." It is the tidier route, not the only one. Anyone reviving this must not patch that by shutting the workplace: engineering the wall back in is what makes it decorative.

The one revival shape that works, and it is a different episode

Stop claiming a wall. Let Ally ask the workplace on day two, because that is what she would obviously do. It is lawful and reasonable, and it is what gets back to Dean. Her ordinary competent question becomes the thing that starts the clock. The episode stops being about a wall she cannot get through and becomes about a mistake she made, which is better drama and fixes the "antagonist arrives too late" finding harder than v3.0 did.

Cost of that route: the spine below is rebuilt from scratch, the v3.0 engine is gone, and the crime underneath stays the most-told homicide pattern there is. That is why it was set down rather than repaired now.

Also unresolved, and it outlives this premise

Bible §2.3.1 makes publishing a recording without consent an offence; §2.3.1b implies publishing a Tip Line message is Ally's choice each time. Those two sections do not agree. Any episode using Tip Line audio needs that ruling first. See Part J.

Salvage already extracted into `reference_idea_snippets`, so nothing here is load-bearing for anyone else's work. Everything below the line is the parked spine, unchanged.

NO FIXED ADDRESS

THE SPINE, v3.1

Pipeline step 1. `SAS/story-production-pipeline-v1.md`. What actually happened, hour by hour, and what Ally can lawfully reach, from whom, on which day. **No prose. No voice. No cold open.** Those are step 4 and they are written from this page, not before it.

Builds on ChatGPT's v3.0 counterproposal, whose central move is adopted without argument: naming the dead woman is the means of reaching the living one. Supersedes `episode-1-candidate-no-fixed-address-v2.1.md`, which the same audit correctly reworked.

Status: not canon, not a pass. This document exists to be attacked (step 3) and then written from (step 4).

o. THE CARE LINE

Per bible §1.4b. Three plain sentences, no proper nouns, no trade terms, at each level.

Episode. A woman died and the city wrote her down as nobody. The man who killed her is living with the woman who rang to say so, and the call cut off before she said where she was. Every day nobody finds out who the dead woman was is another day nobody can find the living one.

Phase One, leads 1 to 7. A frightened woman rang for help and cannot be rung back. Nobody knows her name, where she works or who she is with. The only door into her life is the dead woman she called about.

Phase Two, leads 9 to 13. A woman is being taken out of the city on Friday by the man she called about. Nobody knows whether she is going willingly. What Ally does this week decides whether anyone reaches her first.

Phase Three, leads 14 to 16. A man is nine hours from leaving with the only person who can say what he did. Nobody knows whether a public warning saves her or empties his van. Whichever way Ally goes, the other thing is gone.

PART A. WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

All dates are canon-internal. Present year is the game's now; the killing is the previous November.

A1. Before, 2 September to 6 November

When	What
Until 2 Sep	Kerry Nolan, 34, lives with Dean Iles, 37, in Harbor Ward. He has never hit her. The control is money, her phone, and who she is allowed to see. There is nothing to report and she knows it. No complaint, no order, no record anywhere connecting her name to his
2 Sep	She leaves with a bag while he is at work. New phone number. Tells her mother only that she has left him and is fine, and refuses to say where. Maureen does not push
mid Sep	Rents a room in a shared house on Foundry Lane, Rivermouth . Cash weekly, no lease, her name on nothing
late Sep	Signs on with Bayline Contract Cleaning , night crew, Hart Civic Center , Downtown Civic Row. Mondays, Tuesdays, Thursdays, Sundays, 22:00 to 06:00
Oct	Meets Leah Mercer , 29, on the same crew. Workmates, not friends: the same van in, the same 02:00 break
★ ongoing	Kerry changed her phone. She never changed her post. Her agency payslip envelopes keep going to the Harbor Ward address, where Dean opens them. That is how he learns she is cleaning nights for Bayline. She was found because she forgot to redirect her mail

A2. The approach, 6 to 12 November

When	What
Thu 6 Nov, 21:40	Dean at the Civic Center loading dock at crew arrival. Asks for Kerry by first name. The crew is agency casual and a man asking for someone is not an event. Leah tells him which nights Kerry works. He says he is her brother-in-law. He leaves
Mon 10 Nov, 06:10	Dean waits at the dock at shift end. Follows Kerry, bus then walk, to Foundry Lane. Does not approach. Now he has the address
Tue 11 Nov	Nothing. He decides on Wednesday because it is her night off and she will be in

A3. The night, Wednesday 12 November

Time	What
19:20	Dean parks the van two doors down on Foundry Lane
19:35	The housemate, Ruth Ojo , 24, leaves for an evening shift. Kerry is alone in the house
19:50	He knocks. She opens. He is calm. He asks her to come home
20:05	She refuses and asks him to leave. He does not raise his voice. He does not leave
20:20	She says she is going to call someone. He takes her phone off the table. She reaches for it
20:22	He hits her once, open handed and hard, across the side of the head. She goes down and the back of her skull strikes the raised tiled hearth. She does not get up
20:22 to 20:50	He tries to bring her round. She dies where she is. Single blunt impact, back of the skull
20:50 to 22:40	He sits in the room for nearly two hours. This is why there is no cleanup worth the name
22:40	He takes her phone, her purse, her keys, and the two things in the room with her name on them: an agency payslip envelope and one piece of mail. He leaves her clothes, her bedding, her tea things
22:55	Carries her to the van by the side path. Rain since 21:00, 6°C, nobody on Foundry Lane
23:20	Drives to the service road under the Stonebridge Viaduct , north side. Twenty minutes
23:35	Lays her at the foot of the embankment steps on the wet concrete. Leaves
23:50	Home

Why the steps, and it is the title. He did not need her to be unfindable. He needed her to be **unremarkable**. A woman at the foot of wet steps in November is a woman who fell. A woman under that bridge is a woman nobody is looking for. **He was right about both, and being right about the second one is the crime the episode is actually about.**

The fatal act is deliberate and it is stated once. He did not arrive planning to kill her. He decided to hit her. Per bible §1.3 as amended, the physical detail exists to establish mechanism and is not staged.

A4. The eight months, 13 November to 17 July

When	What
13 Nov, 06:40	A commuter on the Bayline steps calls it in
13 Nov, 07:10 to 11:00	Uniform and scene exam. Single impact consistent with a fall down wet steps. No bag, no phone, no identification. No suspicious circumstances recorded. Entered as unidentified female, 30 to 45, no fixed address presumed
13 to 20 Nov	Post mortem. Single blunt impact to the back of the skull, consistent with a fall. No defensive injuries, no other trauma. Prints taken and searched: no match , because Kerry was never printed for anything. Dental chart recorded. DNA profile obtained and stored
14 to 21 Nov	Camp canvass at Stonebridge. Residents say she is not one of theirs. There is no register of who lives under a bridge , so that neither confirms the classification nor removes it. The record keeps what the scene said
17 Nov	Bayline marks Kerry no-show three times, deactivates her file, replaces her on the roster. Leah takes her Monday and Thursday shifts
24 Nov	Public unidentified-person notice issued. Description, location, date. No name
28 Nov	Maureen Nolan , 61, Kerry's mother, living interstate, has heard nothing since a text on 4 Nov and the number is dead. She walks into her local station and files a missing-person report. She gives a photograph from last year and names Dean Iles as the partner Kerry left . She does not know Kerry is in Havenbay; Kerry said only that she had moved to the coast
30 Nov	The interstate force does what a low-risk adult report gets. It phones the named contact. Dean takes that call . He says she left him in September and he does not know where she went. Both true. Classified low-risk, voluntarily absent , file kept open, no biometric reference sought from Maureen because nobody believes she is dead
5 Dec	The Foundry Lane landlord finds the rent unpaid, bags Kerry's things into a cupboard, re-lets the room. A cash lodger who leaves is not an event. He does not report it
Dec	Maureen posts a public appeal to a national missing-persons page: Kerry Nolan, 34, last contact 4 November . Havenbay is not named in it because Maureen does not know it. Nobody in Havenbay ever sees it
Dec to Jul	Maureen keeps paying Kerry's phone account so the number stays connected, and keeps ringing it

When	What
throughout	The Havenbay file sits open pending identification. No inquest, because there is nobody to hold one about. The death is recorded non-suspicious. Nobody is wrong

A5. The nine days

When	What
Fri 17 Jul	HCPD re-issues the eight-month appeal with a facial reconstruction. Local news, social. Routine, and it is the trigger for everything that follows
Sat 18 Jul, evening	Leah sees it and recognises Kerry. She says nothing
Sun 19 Jul	She asks Dean, sideways, whether he ever knew a Kerry at the Civic Center. He says he never met her. She knows that is a lie, because she is the one who told him Kerry's shifts. From this day he drives her to work and waits
Mon 20 Jul	She does not sleep
Tue 21 Jul, 23:11	Leah rings the <i>Echoes of Havenbay</i> Tip Line from the Civic Center staff corridor, on her own phone, four minutes after the end of her evening shift. 41 seconds. She gives: the dead woman under Stonebridge is called Kerry · she cleaned nights at this building · a man came asking which nights Kerry worked · she told him · three days later Kerry stopped coming in · that man lives with her now and says he never met her
23:14	A staff door. Keys. A man's voice. The line ends. She does not give her name, her shift or an address, and the Tip Line keeps a voice, a date and a time and no caller metadata , because that promise is the only reason anyone uses it
23:14 to 23:40	Dean asks who she was calling. She says her sister. He asks for her phone. She gives it. He sees one Havenbay number, 23:11, three minutes. He does not recognise it. He does not shout
Wed 22 Jul, 08:20	He rings the number from his own phone. It answers with the Tip Line greeting. He hangs up. Now he knows, and it cost him nothing
Wed 22 Jul	He keeps her phone ("yours is playing up, use mine"). He tells her his brother has a place up the coast and they are going for a fortnight. He rings her supervisor and says she is taking leave from Friday the 24th. He books two foot-passenger tickets, Harbor Ferry Terminal, Friday 31 July, 07:15
Wed 22 Jul	Ally plays the message. This is Day 1

Why he does not simply go alone, and it is the least-cost answer the whole antagonist rests on. Leah is the only living person who can put him at the Civic Center asking for Kerry by name. Leaving her behind leaves that witness in Havenbay with a grievance. He needs her with him, calm and cooperative, and that takes days of ordinary behaviour, not violence. **Killing her would create the exact investigation he has spent eight months not having.**

PART B. WHY NO PROFESSIONAL FOUND HER

One causal version chosen for each route. No "may or may not."

Route	Why it produced nothing
Fingerprints	Taken post mortem and searched correctly against the databases Havenbay holds. Kerry has no record and never held a role requiring printing. A correct search of a database she was never in returns nothing
Dental	Confirmatory, not searching. It compares a body to a named candidate. There was no candidate
DNA	Requires a family reference sample. None was ever collected, because the missing-person report did not suggest anyone was dead
The interstate report	Correctly classified low-risk, voluntarily absent: an adult who left a partner, changed her number and chose not to be found. Under R16 that jurisdiction does not participate in the cross-jurisdictional system Havenbay searches, so the report was never entered into it. This is the chosen version
Havenbay's own missing-persons search	Run correctly against local reports. Kerry was never reported missing in Havenbay, because nobody in Havenbay knew her
Maureen's public appeal	Posted where appeals go, naming no city, because Maureen did not know which coast. Havenbay never saw it
The employer	A no-show casual is deactivated and replaced. That is the procedure and it is not a failure
The landlord	A cash lodger who stops paying has left. He bags the room and re-lets it. Also not a failure
The camps	Canvassed. "Not one of ours" from a population with no register removes nothing

★ **The one fact no professional ever had is her first name.** Every route above needs a candidate and none of them can produce one. **Leah's 41 seconds supply the candidate. That is the entire reason a podcaster gets there and a competent police force did not,** and it is why the episode is fair.

What it costs Maureen, and it is the theme. The classification that said *she has probably just left* is the same classification that meant nobody took her mother's DNA. The system was not wrong about the risk. It

was wrong about Kerry, and it was wrong in the direction that costs nothing to be wrong in.

PART C. THE ACCESS LEDGER

C1. What Ally can lawfully reach

Day	Item	Held by	Authority	What it gives
1	The 41-second message	Ally / the show	Caller consented by leaving it, §2.3.1b	The first name, the workplace, the man, and Leah's own admission
1	The public unidentified-person notice and reconstruction	Public record	Published by HCPD	Found at the foot of the Stonebridge steps, 13 Nov 06:40. Female 30 to 45. No bag, no phone, no identification
1	Weather and visibility, 12 to 13 Nov	Public register	R2, permanent and public	Rain from 21:00, 6°C. The steps were wet. Corroborates a fall and, later, corroborates a carry
2	Del Cruz	HCPD	She may receive the message under the police-disclosure exception, §2.3.1	Confirms the death is recorded non-suspicious and the file open pending identification. And then tells Ally what she cannot do
3	The national missing-persons appeal	Public	Anyone may search it	Kerry Nolan, 34, last contact 4 November. The match is name plus age plus date
4	Maureen Nolan	Herself	Her own property, her own consent	Her copy of the report, last year's photograph, Kerry's last texts, the fact Kerry left Dean, the report naming Dean, the phone account she still pays
5	Kerry's dentist, interstate	The practice	Releasable to police on a named candidate; to next of kin under R10	Faster than DNA once a candidate exists
6	Nova Skye	Herself	She interprets her own work and controls whether the network may be used	The under-bridge record of vehicles on the service road at night. Corroboration, never the spine

Day	Item	Held by	Authority	What it gives
8+	Dean Iles	Himself	He agrees to talk	A warm, useful, fixed account, wrong about one thing
8+	Osei Mensah, the Civic Center supervisor	Himself	He may talk if he chooses	Confirms Kerry's shifts, the no-show, and who replaced her. Also the route that can get Leah hurt
12+	Ruth Ojo, the former housemate	Herself	Her own recollection	Kerry was in the house on the 12th and gone on the 13th. Reachable only after police have the address
14+	Whatever HCPD may lawfully state	HCPD / coroner	Ally receives statements, never material	Identification confirmed, the room examined, the case reclassified

C2. What is closed, and stays closed

Item	Why
The coronial file, the post-mortem report, scene photographs, running sheets	R5. Findings and tendered evidence go to next of kin. Notes and unused material stay closed. Ally is not next of kin, and Maureen only becomes next of kin after identification
CCTV of 12 to 13 November	R7. Thirty-one days. Gone by mid-December, never flagged, because nothing was suspicious. There is no footage. There will never be footage
Bayline's roster and employment records	R8. Commercial operational data, held seven years, held by the agency. Ally has no authority to ask and asking exposes Leah
The ferry booking	R8. Held by the operator. Ally cannot see it. She can only learn about a trip from a person
Kerry's belongings in the landlord's cupboard	Kerry's property. A landlord holding an absent tenant's things has no authority to give them to a private investigator. Reachable only by police, after identification
Event data on Dean's van	R15. Owner's, and police seizure removes all other access
Kerry's phone	Dean binned the handset and the SIM in November. It is not coming back

C3. The wall, stated once and out loud

Ally can reach the workplace on Day 1. **She must not.** The agency will not give a podcaster a roster, and the only way to ask the crew who rang her is to describe the call to people who work beside a woman whose

partner drives her to the door.

For police to approach the workplace lawfully, the death has to stop being non-suspicious. For the death to stop being non-suspicious, **the dead woman needs a name.**

★ **That is the engine, and it is forced rather than asserted: naming Kerry is not the elegant route to Leah, it is the only lawful one.**

PART D. THE ANTAGONIST'S LEAST-COST LEDGER

From	His cheapest action	Why
13 Nov to 21 Jul	Nothing	She has no name. Every action he could take makes him more visible, not less
22 Jul, after the callback	Control, not violence	Take the phone, book the ferry, call it a surprise trip, be pleasant. A second body is the investigation he has avoided for eight months
Once Kerry is a named candidate	Cooperate	Maureen's report names him as the former partner, so he will be found. Refusing draws the attention that silence used to buy. He is warm, volunteers small true things, and uses the interview to learn what Ally holds
If his name is published	Move sooner	Story management stops being cheaper than distance. He brings the departure forward

He is dangerous because his decisions are ordinary and economical. He never predicts the plot. He is not clever. He is a man who is right about which absences a city treats as urgent, and he was right about that before he ever hurt anybody.

PART E. THE CLOCK, IN TWO STAGES

v2.1's clock was a cupboard being emptied. The audit was right that a property-disposal date is not jeopardy and dissolves the moment a competent landlord is told. It is deleted.

Stage one, from lead 1, undated. Leah was cut off and she has not rung back. The line keeps no caller metadata, so **she cannot be rung back.** Every lead that passes in silence is the clock. This costs nothing, requires Ally to know nothing she cannot know, and is available in the first forty seconds.

Stage two, from lead 8, dated. Friday 31 July, 07:15, Harbor Ferry Terminal. Set by Dean on 22 July, before Ally had done anything, and it does not move because of anything she does until she forces it to.

Day-stamped, case-born, pause-safe, and **not the same object as the resistance**. Per the clock convention, the session-contained window stays parked.

PART F. SIXTEEN LEADS

Structure only. Every line here is a spine fact, not a scene.

Phase One, leads 1 to 7 — two women, no address

#	What the player does	What changes
1	The message plays	A woman is dead, a man killed her, and the woman saying so is living with him. Murder is explicit and the caller is inside his reach
2	Match "Kerry" and "under Stonebridge" to the public notice	The claim is about a real body in a real open file
3	Del receives the message	Del confirms non-suspicious, file open, and states the wall. Decision 1
4	The appeal search	Nationwide missing "Kerry", the right age, the right fortnight
5	Kerry Nolan, probably	Name plus age plus last contact. Probable, not proved
6	Reach Maureen	The report, the photograph, the last texts, and the name Dean Iles
7	The report names him	Ally learns the man in the call has been a document since November. Decision 2

Midpoint, lead 8 — the names meet

Official comparison confirms Kerry Nolan. The death is reclassified. Police may now lawfully approach the employer, and the supervisor identifies the caller as **Leah Mercer, the cleaner who took Kerry's shifts** and who now lives with Dean Iles. **The player stops naming a dead woman and starts trying to reach a living one.**

★ This is the lead where the merge board has its best shot at the project's rank-one open question. The player assembles a photograph, a date and a name, and **the record visibly changes on screen**. If merging is ever going to change what a player believes, it happens here or it does not happen.

Phase Two, leads 9 to 13 — the helpful man

#	What the player does	What changes
9	Reach Dean	He is warm, useful, abandoned, and wrong about one thing
10	The one wrong thing	He accounts for a night he should have no reason to account for
11	Leah is not at work	A coworker says there is a trip on Friday and that Leah did not sound pleased. The clock becomes a date. Decision 3
12	Corroboration	Nova's record, the weather, the housemate, the room
13	Leah moves, or does not	Both branches leave her under his control longer than anyone wants

Phase Three, leads 14 to 16 — name him or stop him

#	What the player does	What changes
14	The case is now police work	What Ally holds becomes what they hold
15	The last call	Decision 4
16	The terminal	Kerry is named. The death is a homicide. Leah's account explains how he knew. "No fixed address" described the investigation, not her life

PART G. THE FOUR DECISIONS

Four is the shipping plan. A fifth is held in reserve below in case scripting wants it.

#	Lead	Class	Choice	Rejoins
1	3	A	Publish that the woman under Stonebridge may be called Kerry, or keep it with Del	6
2	7	B	Tell Maureen the probable identification now, or verify first	9
3	11	C	Official welfare check, or Nova's quiet route	14
4	15	A	Publish Dean's name, or hold for the intercept	close

Gate arithmetic: four decisions · two Class A · one Class C · every branch rejoins within three · no fork opens before the current branch rejoins (3→6, 7→9, 11→14, 15→16). Leads 10 and 14 are shared.

Decision 1 · lead 3 · Class A · rejoins 6

Publish the name. A crowd of listeners is the fastest instrument Ally owns, and someone who knew a Kerry will ring in. It also tells Dean that somebody told, on a day when the only person who could have is standing in his kitchen. **Keep it with Del.** Leah is protected absolutely and Ally has one route left, the slow one through the appeal.

Neither is obviously right, and the voice is not on the table. The caller's audio is never broadcast on either branch. **The choice is about the dead woman's name, which is the thing the whole episode turns on.**

Irreversible: a warning given, or a week of public help that cannot be bought back.

Decision 2 · lead 7 · Class B · rejoins 9

Tell Maureen now. She gives the reference sample immediately and identification moves weeks. She also tells her sister, her employer and her church before anything is confirmed, and none of it can be untold if Ally is wrong. **Verify first.** Ally gets a second photograph and work corroboration, and Maureen later learns Ally sat on the possibility for three days while she went on paying a dead woman's phone bill.

Irreversible: what Maureen told her family, or Maureen's trust.

Decision 3 · lead 11 · Class C · rejoins 14

Official welfare check. Lawful, immediate, and a uniform at the door. Dean can stand behind Leah while she says she is fine, and then move faster. **Nova's quiet route.** The under-bridge network can put a message where Leah will see it and nobody else will read it. Doing it burns part of a warning system that people who have no other protection depend on, and it puts a named community contact in front of police attention.

⚠ **Kill Gate Zero on this decision:** Del may act on a credible report. **Del may not create a power for Ally.** Whatever the welfare-check branch produces, it is police doing police work and telling Ally only what may lawfully be stated. See ruling question 4.

Irreversible: the element of surprise, or Nova's network.

Decision 4 • lead 15 • Class A • rejoins at the close

Publish his name. Leah gets a warning she can act on and so does everyone else who has ever been in a room with him. He may abandon the ferry, the van and what is in it. **Hold for the intercept.** Del stops the vehicle before boarding and recovers the stronger case. Leah spends the last night under his control.

Irreversible: the evidence in the van, or the hours Leah spends not knowing anyone is coming.

Held in reserve • interview Dean now, or watch him first

Class B, would sit at lead 9. Cut from the shipping four because five decisions in sixteen leads leaves no shared lead between forks. **Add it only if a lead is cut elsewhere.**

Counterfactual

Remove every player decision and: Kerry is still named, weeks later, by an officer rather than by Ally. Maureen still hears it from a stranger. Nova keeps her network. Dean is on the 07:15. **Named people's outcomes change, in both directions, on every branch.**

PART H. THE TWELVE-OBJECTION PRE-FLIGHT

One sentence each. An unanswerable item is a kill, not a note.

Believability

- 1. Why was the decisive material not found at the time?** No professional ever had her first name, and every identification route in Part B requires a candidate before it can do anything.
- 2. Does the antagonist act in his own interest at every point?** Yes, and Part D dates every move: silence while she is nameless, control rather than violence once he knows, cooperation once Maureen's report makes him findable, and speed once he is named.
- 3. Would a real person actually do the small thing this needs them to do?** Leah tells a stranger which nights a workmate is on, which anyone would; Kerry changes her phone and forgets her post, which is ordinary; Maureen keeps paying a phone account so the number still rings, which is the smallest and truest thing in the episode.
- 4. Is the motive one an ordinary reader accepts without argument?** He hit her because she would not come back, and the hearth did the rest.
- 5. Is any discovery a coincidence wearing a coat?** **△ It was, and it is repaired.** In v3.0 the caller happened to be the dead woman's replacement; here **Dean met Leah while hunting Kerry**, so the connection is causal in both directions and Leah's guilt is why she rings at all.

Comprehension

- 6. Does a reader with no context understand every word?** In the spine, no, deliberately; in the opening, **not one procedural word is permitted** and the permitted vocabulary is listed in Part I.
- 7. Can a reader hold the cast in their head on one pass?** △ **Not as written, and Part I says what to cut.**
- 8. Is it clear what the crime is, immediately?** A man killed a woman, the city wrote her down as nobody, and the woman telling you is living with him.

Knowledge and logic

- 9. Can Ally source everything she says she knows?** △ **Not in v3.0, and it is repaired:** she cannot see a ferry booking (R8), so the trip reaches her through a coworker at lead 11, and the whole of Part C exists to make every other fact traceable to a person, a public register or a search.
- 10. Does anything break its own rules?** △ **v3.0's cold open does, in the exact words Trish already killed once. See Part I.**

Stakes

- 11. Is the stake a body, freedom, family, identity or present danger?** All five, and identity is the mechanism rather than a theme.
- 12. Does anything decisive rest on a small number?** No: the 41 seconds and the 07:15 are stamps, the weather is corroboration, and nothing is deduced from arithmetic.

The question that is not on the list

Is the antagonist a person or a mechanism? A person, present from the first forty seconds, standing on the other side of the door while the caller talks.

PART I. WHAT THE PRE-FLIGHT CAUGHT

Seven catches. Five are repaired above. Two are open and need a decision.

★ Catch 1, and it is the worst one. Objection 10.

ChatGPT's v3.0 cold open contains, verbatim:

ALLY: Wait. Where are you?

That is objection 10 in the pre-flight, quoted from Trish, about this exact line, which she has already killed once. Ally is listening to a recording. She cannot ask it anything. It survived into the counterproposal because the counterproposal was written before the pre-flight existed.

Repair, and it is a better beat anyway: Ally hears the cutoff, plays it again, and the second time she hears the keys before the door. **Silence is what a person actually does with a recording**, and the replay is how the audience learns the detail that makes it real.

Catch 2. Kill Gate Zero, not one of the twelve, but it kills a decision.

v3.0's Decision 1 is publishing an excerpt of the caller's voice. Under bible §2.3.1, publishing a recording without the consent of the parties is a separate and stricter offence. §2.3.1b says publication is "Ally's to answer each time," which implies it is available; §2.3.1 says it is an offence. **The two sections do not currently agree.** This is ruling question 1.

Repair, and it does not depend on the ruling: the voice is never broadcast on either branch. Decision 1 becomes **publish the dead woman's name**, which is legally clean, dramatically bigger, and about the thing the episode is actually made of.

Catch 3. Objection 5.

In v3.0 the caller is the dead woman's replacement on the roster, which is a coincidence.

Repaired by making Dean's route to Kerry run through Leah: he asked, she answered, three days later Kerry was gone. Now Leah's call is a confession as much as an accusation, her eight months of silence has a reason, and she has a reason not to go to the police that a reader accepts instantly.

Catch 4. Objection 9.

v3.0 lead 10 has Ally observe a Friday ferry booking. She cannot: booking data is the operator's, held under R8, not disclosable to a private investigator. Repaired by moving the trip onto a person, at lead 11.

Catch 5. Objection 7, and it is not fully repaired.

Count the named cast in v3.0 and the first draft of this spine: Ally, Del, Nova, Kerry, Dean, Leah, Maureen, a cousin, a housemate, a supervisor, a landlord, an agency. **Trish said "too many characters to get my head around" at fewer than that.**

Cut so far: **the cousin is deleted** and her function is now the unredirected post, which is smaller, truer and load-bearing. The landlord and the agency are **unnamed functions**, never speaking.

Still open, and it is Stephen's call: the opening may carry **four names at the outside** — Ally, Kerry, Leah, Dean. Maureen, Del and Nova arrive later or not at all in the first minute. Ruth Ojo and Osei Mensah exist in the spine and should probably not exist on screen.

Catch 6. Objection 6, as a constraint on step 4.

The spine is full of words the opening may not use: **coronial · biometric · cross-jurisdictional · non-suspicious · reclassify · misadventure · post-mortem · next of kin · reference sample · agency casual.**

Permitted vocabulary for the opening: the police, the file, the body, a name, a photograph, her mother, the steps, the bridge, a shift, a van, the ferry. **If the opening needs a procedural word to make sense, the opening is wrong, not the reader.**

Catch 7. Objection 1, and this is the spine's weakest joint. Recorded, not dressed up.

Maureen filed a report naming the ex-partner and posted a public appeal, and **neither ever reached Havenbay.** The reasons are each individually true: she did not know which city, the appeal named no city, and R16 makes cross-jurisdictional entry voluntary and patchy. But a sharp reader can push here, and there is a second push behind it: **for a low-risk voluntarily-absent adult, no financial or employment**

checks are made, which is correct practice and is also the sort of correct practice a reader can mistake for laziness.

This joint is the one thing in the spine most likely to break under ChatGPT's step 3 attack, and it should be attacked there first.

PART J. RULING QUESTIONS

Asked, not invented, per the standing practice in §2.3.2.

#	Question	What turns on it	My recommendation
1	Does the Tip Line greeting carry the caller's consent to broadcast? §2.3.1 makes publishing an offence without consent; §2.3.1b implies publication is Ally's choice	Whether Ally may ever air any Tip Line audio, in this episode or any other	Yes. The greeting says calls may be used on the show, so the caller consents by leaving one. Publication then stays an ethical decision with a real cost, which is what §2.3.1b clearly intends
2	What is the trigger and the authority to move a death from non-suspicious to suspicious where the file is open pending identification and no inquest has been held?	Lead 8, and every police action after it	The identification itself, on a named candidate whose partner is a named contact. This replaces v2.1's "amend a finding of misadventure," which was harder and less true
3	Who may formally identify a deceased person in Havenbay, and what happens when a family in another jurisdiction comes forward? Carried over unanswered from v2.1 §7	Leads 6 to 8 and Decision 2	Left to Stephen
4	What may Del lawfully do on a third-party report of possible coercive control where the reporting person is unnamed and unlocated?	Decision 3, and whether the welfare-check branch exists at all	Left to Stephen. Kill Gate Zero binds harder here than anywhere else in the episode

PART K. RISKS RECORDED

1. The crime is the most-told homicide pattern there is. A woman leaves a controlling partner and he kills her. All the freshness sits in the double erasure: the dead woman has no name, the living woman has no address, and each is the key to the other. ChatGPT's audit said that if a spoken test does not strongly prefer this, the premise should be retired rather than repaired a fourth time. **That is correct and it should be honoured.**

2. ⚠ Representation, and it is urgent because four cases get chosen together. This episode has two women in danger from one intimate partner. The retained seed from the reader test is an unnamed woman under a viaduct. **If all four episodes are young women killed by partners, we will have reproduced the pattern the genre research names, deliberately and at pitch stage.**

What partly answers it here: the episode's actual subject is **which absences a city treats as urgent**, which is the same critique the research levels at the genre, made into the mechanism rather than the moral. That is a defence of this episode. **It is not a defence of four.** Episodes 2 to 4 should be checked against this one before any of them is developed.

3. The Tip Line opening is the second one. The Listener opened on the line too. §2.3.1b rules the device is a signature rather than a liability and that what failed was the absence of jeopardy. **The spoken test decides whether it reads as a sharpened signature or as repetition, and that question should be asked of readers directly.**

4. Nothing here tests whether merging changes what a player believes, which the alignment audit ranked as the project's number one gap. Lead 8 is the best shot the spine offers. **The evidence-turn test should run in parallel with the prose, not after it.**

PART L. PRODUCTION ENVELOPE

- **Sixteen leads, three phases, four decisions.** One Class C, so one materially different route to build.
 - **Existing cast:** Ally, Del, Nova. **New speaking portraits:** Maureen, Dean, Leah. Kerry appears only as photographs. That is three new portraits, one fewer than v3.0.
 - **Locations:** the studio, the Stonebridge Viaduct and its service road, the Hart Civic Center staff door and car park, one Rivermouth residential exterior, the Harbor Ferry Terminal approach. Four of the five are canon and reusable.
 - **No body is shown.** The fatal act is described once, and only where it establishes mechanism.
 - **Code facts, verified this session, so nobody re-fixes them:**
 - ☒ **The twelve-lead counter is fixed.** `LeadsBarView.CaseArcTotal` derives from the database and is covered by `LeadsBarCounterTests`. **v2.1's producer note is stale; delete it.**
 - ☒ `requiresFlag` / `forbidsFlag` shipped and tested; the branch structure is supported.
 - **⚠ `CaseResolutionService.cs:12` still hardcodes `const string EpisodeId = "e1_the_listener"`.** Episode-complete analytics currently report the demoted episode. **This must be fixed before any new Episode 1 ships**, and it is the first visible edge of the missing multi-episode system.
-

NEXT

Step 3: ChatGPT attacks this spine. Point it at Part I catch 7 first, then Part D, then the Part G gate arithmetic.

Step 4: Fable writes one opening from the repaired spine. One. Not six. With the Part I catch 6 vocabulary list, the four-name cap, and the replay beat instead of "Wait. Where are you."

Step 5: two questions. Does it grab you. Do you believe it.